Transport Corporation of India Ltd

Concall tracker report · Q2 2027 (Sep 2026 quarter) · prepared 11 Nov 2026

1. Snapshot

A logistics company that moves goods for businesses by road (freight), runs warehouses and transport contracts for companies (supply chain), and carries containers along India's coast in its own ships (seaways). It also has joint ventures with Concor (rail), a cold-chain business and a transport-for-autos venture.

- Market cap about Rs 6,481 cr: what the market values the whole company at.
- FY26 sales Rs 4,225 cr, up 7%: steady but slow growth.
- FY26 net profit Rs 444 cr: about a tenth of sales ends up as profit, helped by joint-venture income and a low tax rate.
- Operating margin about 11% for several years: flat, not expanding.
- Sep 2026 quarter: sales Rs 1,185 cr, up 13% on a year ago, but net profit Rs 92 cr vs Rs 88 cr, barely up.
- Borrowings rose to about Rs 405 cr after a Rs 150 cr buyback and heavy capex; promoter stake now about 70% after the buyback.

2. Concall coverage

Quarter / source	Date	Read?
Q3 FY24	Feb 2024	Yes (skimmed)
Q4 FY24	May 2024	Yes (skimmed)
Q1 FY25	Jul 2024	Yes (skimmed)
Q2 FY25	Oct 2024	Yes (skimmed)
Q3 FY25	Jan 2025	Yes (skimmed)
Q4 FY25	May 2025	Yes
Q2 FY26	Oct 2025	Yes
Q3 FY26	Feb 2026	Yes
Q4 FY26	Jun 2026	Yes
Q1 FY27	Aug 2026	Yes
Q2 FY27	30 Oct 2026	Yes, in full

Eleven calls across about three years. Older calls were read for guidance and promises; the latest call was read in full.

Latest concall highlights - Q2 FY27 (30 Oct 2026)

- Sales grew close to 15% in the quarter on a consolidated basis, but profit was flat because joint-venture dividends came in lower.
- Took delivery of the first new 500-container ship, TCI Setu, on 29 Oct 2026; it starts work near the end of November. The second new ship is due in early January.
- Guidance held at 10-12% growth in both sales and profit for FY27; management said FY28 should be on the higher side as the new ships work a full year.
- Freight business: about two-thirds of the quarter's growth came from price rises passed on for higher diesel. Management called this year a period of rebuilding, with a leadership change in that division.

- Supply chain grew about 10% off a high base, with a strong pipeline of new transport and warehouse contracts; cold chain grew about 50% on quick-commerce contracts.

Business mix & capacity

- Domestic vs export: management calls it a domestically focused company; the ships may take some trips to Colombo or South-East Asia but demand is mostly Indian. No exact split given.
- Capacity: the seaways fleet is about 78,000 tonnes; the two new ships add roughly 17-18%, with full effect in FY28. Target is about a lakh tonnes by the end of FY30. Capex this year about Rs 500-600 cr.

3. Earning trigger thesis

The main earnings story is new capacity: two new ships for the coastal business, more trucks, rail rakes and warehouse equipment for supply chain, plus new contracts in supply chain and cold chain. These are only just arriving, so the payoff is mostly FY28. Meanwhile the freight business has been stuck at low margins, and fuel swings make the ship business hard to predict.

Trigger	What management said	Evidence so far	Time horizon	Strength
Two new ships (seaways)	Brand-new ships, first expected Sep 2026, second around Jan 2027; FY28 to see the full effect	First ship TCI Setu delivered 29 Oct 2026, about a month later than said in the August call	FY28	Moderate: real capacity, but fuel and freight rates swing
Supply chain contracts	Strong pipeline in auto and warehousing; teens growth	Grew about 10% this quarter off a high base	FY27-FY28	Moderate
Freight business rebuild	More LTL (smaller part-load shipments) and new leadership	LTL share still about 37%; margins flat; growth mostly price	Unclear	Weak: promised for years
Cold chain JV	About 40% growth outlook	Grew about 50% on quick-commerce contracts	Ongoing	Moderate, but small

3b. Trigger check

Trigger type	Yes/ No	What was said (date)
Debt cut	No	Debt is rising: net debt seen at about Rs 150-200 cr by FY27 end (Oct 2026)
New business	No	Integrated rail-plus-warehouse service for a consumer-staples customer is still an experiment
Margin up	No	Freight margins 'lowish to flattish'; seaways margin guided to settle at 30-40%
New management	No	Only a leadership change inside the freight division, no new CEO/MD/CFO
New capacity	Yes	'Yesterday we took delivery of the first ship... TCI Setu'; second ship early January (Oct 2026)
Big orders	Yes	'Very strong pipeline in terms of contracts, both on the transportation side, as well as on the warehouse side' (Oct 2026)
Turnaround	No	Not applicable
Promoter buying	No	Promoter stake rose to about 70% only because of the buyback

Single concrete driver: Two new coastal container ships (TCI Setu delivered Oct 2026, a second due Jan 2027) plus new supply-chain contracts, with the full effect in FY28.

4. Management consistency scorecard

Period	What was promised	What actually happened	Verdict
FY25 (May 2025 call)	10-15% sales growth, 15-20% profit growth	Management said the guidance was achieved	Delivered
FY26 (Oct 2025 / Feb 2026)	10-12% sales, 10-15% profit growth	Sales came in about 9.5%, slightly short (Jun 2026 call)	Partly
Freight (2024-2026)	Push the LTL share higher; challenges to ease in 'one or two quarters' (Feb 2026)	LTL share still about 37%, margins flat; growth mostly from diesel pass-through	Missed
New ships (2024-2026)	Order brand-new ships; first by Sep 2026 end (Aug 2026 call)	First ship delivered 29 Oct 2026, second due Jan 2027	Partly (about a month late)
FY27 guidance	10-12% growth in sales and profit	Held in Oct 2026; first half profit flat	Too early

The overall story has been steady for years: low double-digit growth, investment in ships, trucks and warehouses, and a freight business that keeps being 'rebuilt'. Guidance is usually close to met. The weak spot is freight, where the LTL push and margin recovery keep getting pushed out.

5. Bottom line

Durable earning trigger? → MAYBE

There's a real driver in the new ships and supply-chain contracts, but they're only just arriving and won't show fully until FY28. Fuel costs and freight rates can swing the ship profits either way, and freight is still a drag.

Management consistent? → MAYBE

Management usually gets close to its guidance and the ships did arrive, but FY26 fell slightly short, the first ship came a month late and the freight turnaround has been promised for years without showing up.

6. Checkpoints for next quarter

- TCI Setu and the second new ship are both working by the Q3 call
- Profit grows on a year ago in the December quarter
- FY27 guidance of 10-12% growth is held

Sources

- Screener.in TCI financials and concall transcripts (Feb 2024 to Oct 2026)
- TCI Q2 FY27 investor call transcript, 30 Oct 2026 (filed 5 Nov 2026)

This is not investment advice. Do your own due diligence.